

Asthma – Medical Summary

Overview

Asthma is a chronic respiratory condition in which the airways become inflamed and narrowed. Symptoms can vary over time and may worsen after exposure to certain triggers.

Common Symptoms

Wheezing, coughing, shortness of breath, and chest tightness are common symptoms. Symptoms may become more noticeable during an asthma episode.

Common Triggers

Possible triggers include dust, dust mites, pollen, smoke, air pollution, respiratory infections, cold air, exercise, and certain allergens.

Diagnosis

Healthcare professionals may assess symptoms and medical history and may use breathing tests such as spirometry to evaluate lung function.

Management

Management commonly involves avoiding known triggers and using prescribed medications. Inhaled medicines may be used for long-term control or rapid relief depending on the treatment plan.

Asthma Exacerbation

During an asthma exacerbation, symptoms can become significantly worse. Severe breathing difficulty requires urgent medical evaluation.

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